Joe Bader

Engineering leader and hands-on builder of production AI agents, their evaluations, and their safety controls

Philadelphia, PA 19129 | joseph.bader@gmail.com | joebader.com | linkedin.com/in/josephbader

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 20+ years building teams and production systems, now focused on AI agents that finish real work safely. As Senior Manager at Riskonnect, led and mentored five engineering teams, raised on-time delivery from 30% to 95%, and helped introduce AI-assisted engineering. As founder of Tuner Logic, personally built a safety-sensitive AI assistant and the multi-agent platform that develops it, where agents author 100% of commits in isolated environments, with limited permissions and human review. Earlier, led client engagements as technical lead at Intuitive Company, now part of EY.

TECHNICAL

Leadership: Team leadership and mentoring, executive and stakeholder communication, roadmap planning, architecture review, DORA metrics and OKRs, resource allocation
Agent Engineering: Model APIs (Cloudflare Workers AI, Anthropic, OpenAI), tool calling, structured outputs (Zod), context engineering, model routing, multi-agent orchestration, Agent Client Protocol (ACP), Claude Code, Codex
Evaluation & Controls: Task-based evals, tool-call trajectory scoring, regression guards, sandboxed execution, scoped bot identities, human approval gates, audit logging
Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, Bash, Ruby, .NET, PHP; React, Node.js, Hono, Drizzle, Rails
Cloud & Infrastructure: Cloudflare (Workers, D1, R2), AWS, Azure, Linux, Docker, Podman, Kubernetes, Terraform
CI/CD & Testing: GitHub Actions, Gitea Actions, Jenkins, CircleCI, Azure DevOps, Playwright, Vitest

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal Engineer *07/2025 - Present*
Tuner Logic (tunerlogic.com) | Remote

- Founded Tuner Logic, an AI-assisted SaaS for automotive performance tuning, where a wrong answer can damage an engine. Sole architect of the product and its delivery platform, from concept through production deployment (3,300+ agent-authored commits under my direction and review).
- Built the product's AI assistant in TypeScript on Cloudflare Workers. It answers tuning questions by calling 13 tools that read the user's own calibration, log, and dyno data, checks each response against a fixed format, and limits how many steps it can take.
- Kept the model away from decisions where it could do harm. Corrections and safety checks are calculated by regular code, not the model. Values the model writes for fuel, ignition, and boost tables are held back, and no edit is applied until the user reviews and accepts it. Unsafe requests are refused by fixed rules, in ten languages.
- Chose models on evidence. A nightly test runs each candidate model through realistic tasks and checks every step it takes against fixed rules, not another model's opinion. Model changes go through a reviewed pull request, and a model that starts failing in production is removed automatically.
- Built the multi-agent platform that develops the product. Labeling an issue starts a supervised coding agent in its own isolated copy of the code, using any of six coding-agent tools. Agents author 100% of commits, and any session can be watched or taken over from a dashboard or phone.
- Made long-running agent work recoverable: instructions are saved before an agent starts, the same task never starts twice, and stuck sessions are cleaned up automatically. Added these safeguards after diagnosing live failures, with tests to prevent repeats.
- Limited what each agent can do. Coding and review agents use separate accounts with narrow permissions, so the agent that writes code cannot approve it and the reviewer cannot change it. Review agents run in isolated containers and treat the content they review as untrusted.
- Automated the path to production without giving up control. Changes merge only when the exact version being merged has been approved (250+ batches in the first two weeks). The system retries when infrastructure fails and removes the change that broke a batch. A Python release service keeps production credentials away from the build system.
- Held the product to safety-engineering standards: 100% test coverage of backend code, targets modeled on the ISO 26262 automotive safety standard, health checks every five minutes, and practiced restores.

Senior Manager, Software Engineering *12/2021 - 12/2025*
Riskonnect | Remote

- Led and mentored five cross-functional engineering teams (5–8 engineers each) on a core B2B SaaS platform, improving on-time delivery from 30% to 95% while meeting reliability targets.

- Mentored team leads and senior engineers, reported delivery, risk, and milestones to executives, and managed resource allocation across the five teams.
- Partnered with product and engineering leadership to sequence multi-quarter initiatives and manage stakeholder communications, improving roadmap predictability.
- Established engineering OKRs, delivery metrics, and review cadences that improved lead time for changes by 4x.
- Increased pull request throughput by 40% across five teams by applying industry-standard engineering discipline.
- Helped introduce AI-assisted engineering practices, and led a migration of a legacy Bootstrap interface carried out by AI agents across thousands of UI files.
- Reviewed architecture for high-impact initiatives, catching weak designs before implementation and reducing long-term platform risk.

Lead Software Engineer (Contract) *10/2018 - 07/2021*

Comcast (via TEKsystems) | Philadelphia, PA

- Delivered four high-visibility initiatives as a lead engineer across Comcast's digital sales and account management platforms, including the Allspark transformation team and Buy Online, Pick Up In-Store across five applications and services.
- Contributed to the re-architecture of high-traffic customer-facing systems serving millions of users, reducing critical page latency and production defect rates.
- Owned billing, consent, and call-center workflows tied to revenue and compliance, including a Consent UI handling millions of legal acceptance records.

Managing Partner & CTO *10/2017 - 10/2018*

5 Foot Gorilla, LLC | Philadelphia, PA / Remote

- Co-founded and led a technology consulting firm delivering custom SaaS, web, and mobile solutions from discovery through production launch, owning architecture, execution, and delivery governance.

Principal Software Engineer / Development Manager (Contract) *02/2016 - 09/2017*

Comcast (via FIS Global / Yoh) | Philadelphia, PA

- Helped re-architect Xfinity My Account (about 11 million monthly users) as a lead engineer heading tiger teams. The redesign won the Creativity International Gold Award for Web Redesign.
- Owned billing and payment journeys, among the highest-traffic self-service flows in the application, and partnered across product, design, and service architecture to deliver 26 major releases in 19 months.

Chief Product Officer *05/2015 - 02/2016*

Cnverg | Philadelphia, PA

- Took a prototype-stage product to market in under six months, leading a mixed team of engineers, contractors, and interns through platform hardening that supported 560% user growth and helped secure follow-on venture funding.

User Interface Architect / Tech Lead *11/2013 - 05/2015*

Intuitive Company (now part of EY) | Philadelphia, PA

- Led client-facing technical delivery on multidisciplinary teams across three concurrent enterprise engagements, planning architecture with principals and engagement leads.
- Delivered reusable UI frameworks that made delivery more consistent, and built client relationships that led to follow-on work.

Owner & Principal Engineer *12/2010 - 11/2013*

Gigabuilder LLC | Philadelphia, PA

- Ran an independent software practice delivering custom SaaS platforms, completing 25+ projects across healthcare, e-commerce, and media with 90% repeat-client business and 95% on-time delivery, bringing on contractors for larger engagements.
- Designed cloud architectures on AWS and Heroku and scaled hosting infrastructure for high-traffic applications.

Senior Front-End Developer *05/2010 - 11/2010*

Band Digital (formerly Whittman-Hart) | Philadelphia, PA

- Built interfaces and maintained hosting for high-profile clients across concurrent projects.

VP of Technology *01/2003 - 01/2005, 01/2006 - 09/2009*

Exam Master Corporation | Philadelphia, PA

- Rewrote Exam Master Online, a high-availability exam delivery platform, and managed IT infrastructure.

User Interface Developer *01/2005 - 01/2006*

cPanel Corporation | Houston, TX

- Redeveloped the cPanel/WHM interface for 12M+ users, improving task completion and time-to-complete by 80%.